

Acme Global Technologies — Comprehensive People Operations & HR Policy Manual (2026)

Version 4.2 • Effective Date: January 1, 2026 • Applies to all Full-Time, Part-Time, and Contract Employees

Chapter 1: Compensation, Payroll & Performance Bonuses

1.1 Payroll Schedule & Direct Deposit: Salaries are disbursed semi-monthly on the 15th and the final business day of each month. If a pay date falls on a weekend or federal holiday, disbursement occurs on the preceding business day.

1.2 Performance Review Cycle & Merit Increases: Formal performance reviews take place bi-annually in June and December. Merit salary increases range from 3.0% to 9.5% based on employee rating (Exceeds Expectations, Consistently Meets, Needs Improvement).

1.3 Annual Discretionary Bonus Tiers: Bonus targets are tied to individual performance and company ARR growth:

Level / Role	Target Bonus (% of Base)	Eligibility Window	Payout Date
L1–L3 (Associate / Mid-Level)	10% – 15%	Completed 6 months continuous tenure	March 15th
L4–L6 (Senior / Staff / Lead)	18% – 25%	Completed 6 months continuous tenure	March 15th
L7+ (Director / VP / Exec)	30% – 50% + Equity Grant	Annual performance milestone review	March 15th

Chapter 2: Leaves, Paid Time Off (PTO) & Holiday Calendar

2.1 Annual PTO Accrual: Full-time employees accrue **24 days of Paid Time Off (PTO)** per year (2.0 days per completed month). Part-time employees accrue 12 days prorated. Employees can carry over up to **5 unused PTO days** into the next calendar year; remaining days expire on Dec 31st.

2.2 PTO Request Lead Times: Requests for 1–2 consecutive days require 48 hours notice. Requests for 3+ consecutive days must be submitted 14 calendar days in advance in BambooHR.

2.3 Sick Leave & Medical Certificates: Employees receive **10 paid sick days** annually (allotted Jan 1). For consecutive medical absences exceeding 3 business days, a signed medical certificate from a licensed doctor must be submitted to hr-medical@acmeglobal.com within 5 days of returning to work.

2.4 Parental Leave: Primary caregivers receive **16 weeks of 100% paid parental leave**. Secondary caregivers receive **6 weeks of 100% paid parental leave**. Applicable for birth, legal adoption, or long-term foster placement within the child's first 12 months.

2.5 Bereavement Leave: 5 consecutive paid days for immediate family members (spouse, child, parent, sibling); 3 consecutive paid days for extended family (grandparent, in-law).

2.6 Sabbatical Leave: Employees with 5+ years of continuous tenure are eligible to apply for an unpaid sabbatical of 1 to 3 months with guaranteed job preservation.

2.7 Official Company Holidays (11 Days): New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Jr. Day, Memorial Day, Juneteenth, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day, Day after Thanksgiving, Christmas Eve, Christmas Day, and 1 Floating Cultural Holiday.

Chapter 3: Remote Work, Home Office & Equipment Stipends

3.1 Core Working Hours: Core synchronous collaboration hours are **10:00 AM to 4:00 PM EST** (or local equivalent). All team members must be responsive on Slack during these hours.

3.2 Home Office Setup Stipend: Full-time remote employees receive a one-time non-taxable stipend of **\$1,000 USD** on their first paycheck for ergonomic desks, monitors, and chairs. Receipts must be uploaded within 60 days.

3.3 Monthly Internet & Mobile Reimbursement: Remote employees are entitled to a monthly internet stipend of **\$80 USD** and a mobile phone reimbursement of **\$50 USD** for on-call personnel.

3.4 Coworking Pass: If an employee prefers a coworking space, the company provides a monthly WeWork / Regus hot-desk membership reimbursement up to **\$250 USD per month**.

Chapter 4: Health, Dental, Vision & Wellness Benefits

4.1 Coverage Start Date: Health benefits take effect on the 1st day of the calendar month following employment commencement (e.g., hire date Sept 15 → coverage starts Oct 1).

4.2 Plans Offered: Cigna Premium PPO (80/20 in-network, \$500 deductible) and Kaiser HDHP with \$1,500 HSA company contribution.

4.3 Annual Wellness Stipend: Each employee receives a **\$600 USD annual wellness allowance**. Reimbursable categories: gym memberships, yoga/Pilates classes, personal training, running shoes, mental health counseling apps (Headspace, BetterHelp), and massage therapy.

Chapter 5: Business Travel & Expense Policy

5.1 Daily Meal Per Diem: Business travel meals are reimbursed up to **\$85 USD per day** (Breakfast: \$20, Lunch: \$25, Dinner: \$40). Alcohol is non-reimbursable unless client entertainment is pre-approved in writing by a VP.

5.2 Flight & Accommodation Rules: Domestic flights under 5 hours must be Economy class. International flights exceeding 6 continuous hours are eligible for Premium Economy or Business Class with VP approval. Hotels are capped at \$250/night (Standard Tier cities) and \$380/night (Tier 1 cities: NYC, SF, London, Tokyo).

5.3 Expense Filing Deadline: All expense reports must be submitted via Expensify within **30 days** of transaction incurrence. Receipts required for all expenses over \$25.

Chapter 6: Resignation, Notice Periods & Offboarding

6.1 Notice Periods: Standard employees (L1–L4) are required to provide **2 weeks (14 calendar days)** written notice. Senior staff, Managers, and Directors (L5+) must provide **4 weeks (30 calendar days)** notice.

6.2 Payout of Accrued PTO: All unused accrued PTO (up to the 24-day cap) is paid out on the final paycheck. Sick leave is non-compensable upon separation.

6.3 Asset Return: Company laptops (MacBook Pro/Dell XPS), security badges, and company credit cards must be returned via prepaid shipping box within **7 business days** of the last working day.